EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 30 OCTOBER 2026

Cité Verte, Kinshasa

In Kinshasa, El Niño's danger is heat, rising every month to March; the floods and gullies that kill on Selembao's slopes come every rainy season regardless. Get the families on the ravine edges out before the night rain, and put oral rehydration salts in every home.

PROVINCE	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Kinshasa (province level)	1,600 forecast, rising to 480 in March; 330 already past (Jun–Sep)	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027	Night floods, gully collapse, and cholera every rainy season; humid heat rising to March

14/14 recommendations checked. 9 corrected, 1 unverified (a "Do not" card kept on one press report), 5 contraindicated (the five "Do not do this" cards). Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review, methods forthcoming. It is published for the whole of Kinshasa, not for Cité Verte, and it counts heat only. It is a model estimate: no study has counted heat deaths in Kinshasa. El Niño does not reliably change Kinshasa's rainfall, so the flood and gully actions here are for every rainy season, not for this El Niño. The funding target fell from the panel's CDF 193 million (US$85,250) to CDF 137 million (US$60,500) after verification (−29%), because Red Cross data show Selembao is not one of Kinshasa's cholera hotspots.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



4.44°S 15.26°E, Dem. Rep. Congo · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Every rainy season, gullies and the Makelele river kill people at night on Selembao's slopes, El Niño or not; what El Niño adds is heat, with Kinshasa's forecast rising to 480 extra deaths in March.
- **For you.** If your house is near a ravine head or the river, agree an uphill place to sleep by 30 November, and leave before the night rain when the radio announces heavy rain.*
- **The money.** CDF 67.8 million (US$30,000) floor, CDF 137 million (US$60,500) target, CDF 979 million (US$433,000) ceiling; chlorine and oral rehydration points through the Selembao health zone buy the most lives.
- **Do not.** Do not fill a gully head with sandbags or rubbish: water undermines the joints and the gully keeps moving, as it did at Kisenso and Mbanza Lemba.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT 9 STEPS

Cité Verte itself is Selembao's one planned estate, with laid-out roads and sewers. The people who die in the rains here live on its edges and in the unplanned streets around it, on sandy slopes above gully heads and beside the Makelele. This season brings the usual storms, from now to May, plus humid heat that builds towards March while the power keeps cutting out. The ranked actions below are written for the commune, the health zone, and their partners. These nine are the ones you can take yourself, grouped by what they protect. Prices marked as estimates are not published anywhere.

1 · Floods and gullies: if you live near a ravine head or the river, agree an uphill place to sleep, and leave before the night rain *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026, then every heavy-rain night to May	None	Everyone asleep in the house

People here die at night, when a wall falls in or water rushes through a house. In April 2025, at least 72 people died in Kinshasa, drowned or crushed by collapsing walls; in June 2025 another 22 died in wall collapses after one night of rain. Agree now with a family uphill, or a church or school, where you will sleep on heavy-rain nights. Mettelsat, the national weather agency, announces heavy rain on the radio and through ACP; there is no text-message alert, so ask your chef de rue to pass the word. On those nights, do not sleep against a wall that faces a gully or the river.*

2 · Your plot: follow where your roof and yard water goes, keep it off the slope, and clean your retention pit after every storm

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026, then after every storm	Your own labour	Your house and your neighbours' below

Gullies in Kinshasa start where water is concentrated: from roofs, roads, gutters, and paths onto sandy slopes. Most plots already have a retention pit, but studies here found they cut runoff by under 20–30%, because they are too small and are not cleaned. If your water reaches a slope or a gully, send it somewhere else. Join the weekly salongo, which the bourgmestre of Selembao runs with the "Selembao Ezo Bonga" brigade, and never tip waste into a drain or ravine: it blocks the water and starts new erosion.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

3 · Cholera and diarrhoea: keep oral rehydration salts and zinc at home, and start them at the first watery stool*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026	About CDF 2,000–3,000 (US$0.90–1.30) for a home supply (estimate)	Children and older people

In July 2025 the health minister said about 80% of cholera deaths in the country happen at home, before people reach care; at the 2025 peak up to 9% of Kinshasa's cases died, against a target of under 1%. Keep four to six sachets of oral rehydration salts (ORS). Without them, mix 6 level teaspoons of sugar and half a level teaspoon of salt in 1 litre of safe water (WHO); keep the word "level". Give children zinc for 10–14 days: 10 mg a day under six months, 20 mg a day from six months to five years. If someone cannot drink or the diarrhoea is very heavy, go at once: call the health zone first, then a cholera treatment centre such as Binza Ozone or Ngiri-Ngiri.*

4 · Water: treat what you drink, and keep two to three days stored before the taps fail*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 3

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Now, through the rains	About CDF 3,400 (US$1.50) a month for tablets (estimate)	Everyone who drinks at home

Only 0.6% of Selembao's residents subscribe to REGIDESO, and in Hérady the public taps were dry for nearly two months in early 2026, so many households buy borehole water. Use chlorine tablets, or eau de Javel: 2 drops of 5–6% bleach per litre of clear water, 4 if it is cloudy, then wait 30 minutes. Local Javel is often weaker than that, so tablets are safer. Store treated water in a covered container before the rains, because the April 2025 floods cut water supply in several communes.*

5 · Malaria: check your nets now, replace worn ones, and get any fever tested within 24 hours*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026		Children under five above all

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

	A market net about CDF 11,300 (US$5) (estimate); ask about a free one

Selembao had some of the highest child malaria rates measured in Kinshasa: 14.1% and 26.8% of young children tested positive in surveys in 2009 and 2011. Kinshasa's last mass net distribution began in January 2024, and nets in DRC field studies lasted a median of only 1.6–2.2 years, so many are worn out now. Nets cut child deaths by about 17% against no net (Cochrane 2018). Nets should be free at antenatal and vaccination visits; ask at the health centre whether they are in stock. A rapid malaria test costs little; ask the relais communautaire whether it is free at your centre.*

6 · Heat, January to March: keep one room cool, keep water close, and look in on older neighbours and babies*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
From 1 Jan 2027	None	Older people, babies, the chronically ill

Kinshasa's heat is humid rather than extreme: highs of about 30–32°C, humidity of 75–85%, and nights near 22°C that give little relief, under tôle roofs. Climate Impact Lab forecasts Kinshasa's extra heat deaths rising every month, from 240 in December to 480 in March. Power cuts are getting worse, so do not count on a fan. Shade the roof side of the room you sleep in, open it to the night air, drink often, and check daily on anyone old, ill, or living alone, and on babies.*

7 · Food: share a sack of cassava chips with three or four households in mid-December, not earlier

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 8

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Dec 2026	About CDF 40,000–43,000 (US$18–19) per household (sack CDF 160,000–170,000)	The household when roads are cut in the rains

Kinshasa grows little of its own food, and its cassava comes by road from Kongo Central and Kwilu. Prices are falling: at the Matadi-Kibala market a sack from Kongo Central dropped from CDF 190,000 to 170,000 in October 2026, and prices are about a quarter below

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

June. So there is no gain in buying early. A shared sack in mid-December covers the weeks when Route Nationale 1 can be cut by rain and erosion.

8 · Papers: put your identity and plot papers in a sealed bag, and check with Urbanisme before you buy any plot

CONFIRMED ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Dec 2026	About CDF 500 for a bag (estimate)	Your claim to your home and to any compensation

Floods destroy documents, and compensation after a demolition depends on proof that you lived there. After the April 2025 floods, the governor warned that officials issuing permits or titles in no-build zones would be sanctioned and announced demolitions there after a six-month grace period. Photograph your papers on your phone as well. Before paying for a plot, confirm at Urbanisme that it is not in a no-build zone.

9 · Money: open a mobile money account in your own name, with your own identity card

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026	Usually free to open; confirm with the agent	Access to emergency cash and to help from relatives

Emergency cash in Kinshasa has been paid by mobile money before. M-Pesa, Orange Money, and Airtel Money all require identity checks with a voter card or passport. In March 2026 the government debated re-registering SIM cards in Kinshasa, so a line registered in someone else's name could be cut off.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask your **chef de quartier** whether your street is on the ravine-edge list, and where the night refuge is (action 1).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- Ask the **Selembao health zone** where the nearest oral rehydration point and cholera treatment centre are (action 2).
- Ask the **bourgmestre of Selembao** where the drains above your street empty, and whether Selembao's gullies are on the World Bank PRIUR project's list (action 7).
- Ask your **health centre** whether bed nets are in stock for antenatal and vaccination visits (action 6).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet, but the evidence behind each was checked for whether it came from somewhere like here.

1. List every household on a gully lip or the Makelele bank around Cité Verte, pair each with an uphill refuge, and move people before the night rain on a Mettelsat heavy-rain forecast

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bourgmestre of Selembao, through the chefs de quartier and chefs de rue	List by 30 Nov 2026; refuges agreed by 15 Dec	About CDF 2.26 million (US$1,000) (estimate)	Night deaths from collapsing walls and flash floods

Chefs de rue walk the edges of the Cité Verte estate, Kingu-Camping, Herady, and Ngafani, and the gully heads on the Mont-Ngafula side, and list the households within about 10 metres of a ravine head or the riverbank, flagging older and disabled people. Each is paired with an uphill host family, church, or school. In the 13 December 2022 floods, 169 people died in Kinshasa (OCHA), and Selembao was among the worst-hit communes, with 12 dead in a partial count; in April 2025 at least 72 died, drowned or under collapsing walls. Mettelsat issues heavy-rain forecasts that ACP and radio carry, and in September 2026 told people in risk zones to move before the rains, but there is no public text-message alert and the system is described as outdated, so the chefs de rue are the relay.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the deaths are local and documented; the refuge design has no evaluation here. It works only if people trust it is temporary and not an eviction (see "Do not do this").

2. Open oral rehydration points in Selembao's health areas from November to March, put ORS and zinc in homes, and agree motorbike referral to the nearest cholera treatment centre

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Selembao health zone, with Croix-Rouge volunteers	Open by 15 Dec 2026	CDF 33.9 million (US$15,000) for 10 points	Cholera and diarrhoea deaths at home

ORS may prevent 93% of diarrhoea deaths in children under five, a figure modelled to full coverage; the observed pooled reduction was 69% (Munos et al., *International Journal of Epidemiology* 2010). At the 2025 peak up to 9% of Kinshasa's cholera cases died (Health Ministry; WHO put it near 8%), and in July 2025 the minister said about 80% of deaths happen at home. MSF ended its support to Kinshasa cholera care in early 2026. The Red Cross's 2026 Kinshasa cholera operation ran 80 rehydration points for four months at about CDF 2.35 million (US$1,040) each, all in, so CDF 3.39 million (US$1,500) a point for five months is in range. Nearer treatment centres than Pakadjuma in Limete include Binza Ozone and Ngiri-Ngiri.

Transferability: good for children in low-income settings. We found no current cholera cases in Selembao, which is not one of Kinshasa's hotspots, so this is readiness for the rains, not an outbreak response.

3. Hand out household chlorine to 2,000 of the households with the least safe water, starting where the taps are dry

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Selembao health zone and its CODESA health committees	Start 1 Dec 2026, five months	CDF 33.9 million (US$15,000)	Water-borne disease in households buying borehole water

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Across 18 trials, water treatment cut deaths in children under five by about a quarter (odds ratio 0.76, 95% CI 0.63–0.93; Kremer et al. 2023), at about CDF 90,000 (US$40) per disability-adjusted life year. Only 0.6% of Selembao residents subscribe to REGIDESO, and Hérady's taps were dry for nearly two months in early 2026. The Red Cross's 2026 operation gave tablets to 2,000 households across the whole city, so we sized Selembao at 2,000 households × CDF 3,400 (US$1.50) a month × 5 months, our estimate of the unit cost.

Transferability: good; the trials are from low-income settings with unsafe supply.

4. Send a weekly cholera line list for each Selembao health area to the national cholera programme, so the pre-arranged CERF money can fire here, and press for Selembao in the next vaccine round

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · PUBLIC HEALTH · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Selembao health zone, reporting to PNECHOL-MD	Weekly from 1 Nov 2026	Staff time	Trigger money arriving late, or landing elsewhere

The OCHA/CERF cholera anticipatory-action framework, renewed for 2025–27, pays out on pre-agreed thresholds of suspected cases in a health zone, including after a shock such as a flood. It fired for Kinshasa on 24 July 2025, releasing up to CDF 1.70 billion (US$750,000) for chlorination points and hygiene promotion. The thresholds are not published, but they run on weekly health-zone data, so the speed of Selembao's reporting decides how fast money can arrive. Selembao was not among the seven zones in the 19–23 August 2025 vaccine campaign, which included neighbouring Bumbu; one dose was 52.7% effective at 12–17 months in Uvira, DRC (Malembaka et al., *Lancet Infectious Diseases* 2024).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the framework is built for DRC. A vaccine round is unlikely for a zone that is not a hotspot, so the realistic gain is in reporting.

5. From January to March, have chefs de quartier and churches check daily on older people, babies, and the chronically ill in the hottest houses, with water and shade at health centres

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Selembao health zone, with chefs de quartier and churches	Set up by 31 Dec 2026; run Jan–Mar 2027	About CDF 2.26 million (US$1,000) (estimate)	Heat deaths indoors that are never recorded as heat

This is the only risk here that El Niño clearly adds: Climate Impact Lab forecasts 1,600 extra heat deaths in Kinshasa from October to March, rising each month to 480 in March. They are modelled: no study has counted heat deaths in Kinshasa, and they are likely recorded as malaria, fever, or other causes. Kinshasa's heat is humid, with highs of about 30–32°C and nights near 22°C, made worse by power cuts that worsened through October 2026. Ahmedabad's heat plan is a precedent for a city plan, not an expected effect: it relied on early warnings and dry heat of 45°C, neither of which applies here. No instrument funds heat in Kinshasa.

Transferability: low. The design is cheap and uses networks that already exist, but there is no evidence for it from a humid Central African city.

6. Replace worn bed nets through the health centres before the peak of the rains, and test every fever in a child within 24 hours *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Selembao health zone, with the national malaria programme	31 Dec 2026	Unfunded; a market net about CDF 11,300 (US$5) (estimate)	Child malaria deaths in the rainy season

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Nets cut child deaths from all causes by 17% against no net (rate ratio 0.83, 0.77–0.89; Pryce et al., Cochrane 2018). Selembao's child malaria prevalence was 14.1% in a 2009 dry-season survey and 26.8% in a 2011 rainy-season survey (Ferrari et al., *Malaria Journal* 2016), two separate surveys now 15 years old. Kinshasa's last mass distribution began on 17 January 2024, for 840,243 households, and DRC field studies found nets lasted a median of 1.6–2.2 years. Routine nets at antenatal and vaccination visits are national policy, but supply is patchy. We found no current policy making malaria care free for children in Kinshasa.

Transferability: strong for the net evidence, which is from sub-Saharan Africa; the local prevalence data are dated.

7. Stop the water upstream of the gullies: map where Selembao's drains and Cité Verte's sewers empty, extend them to protected outlets, and run salongo with waste collection arranged first

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bourgmestre of Selembao, with the Office des Voiries et Drainage	Map by 15 Dec 2026; works in the dry season	Not published; ask PRIUR	New gully heads and the loss of houses and roads

In Kinshasa, 43.8% of mega-gullies sit on roads, gutters, and paths (Makanzu Imwangana et al., *Catena* 2015), and a thesis attributes 90% of Selembao's gullying to faulty or unfinished collectors; the Ngafani collector gully took 27 plots in two rains. A drain that stops on a slope is, in one Kinshasa study's words, "un danger énorme". Parcel retention pits exist on 77–88% of plots but cut runoff by under 20–30%. Salongo is active in Selembao every week. The World Bank's PRIUR flood-resilience project (CDF 452 billion, US$200 million, from 2025, starting in Kinshasa) has not named its communes, and Kin La Belle (CDF 565 billion, US$250 million, April 2026) is for waste, which fits the haulage step. Whether Cité Verte's own sewers discharge onto a slope is not known; mapping it is the first task.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the gully evidence is from Kinshasa itself. The works are dry-season jobs; before this peak, only the mapping and the drain clearing are realistic.

8. Watch the price of cassava and the exchange rate weekly, and have wholesalers stock four to six weeks of cassava chips in early to mid December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Selembao commune, with wholesalers at Matadi-Kibala and Zigida	Watch weekly; stock 1–15 Dec 2026	None to watch; stock financed by traders' own credit	Price spikes when rain or erosion cuts Route Nationale 1

The El Niño food signal here is weak: Kinshasa's food comes by road and river, and prices are falling, with cassava chips from Kongo Central down from CDF 190,000 to 170,000 a sack in October 2026 and sacks about 24% below June. Route Nationale 1 was cut at Kasangulu "Neuf Étages" in April 2025, though traffic resumed the same evening. Use the National Statistics Institute's weekly inflation note, which reports Kinshasa separately, ACP's reports from the Matadi-Kibala market, and the gap between the central bank's parallel and indicative rates, which was 2.7% on 9 October; a gap above 5% is the warning. The national CAID food basket is not a usable trigger: it excludes Kinshasa and appears a month late. Selembao has no market of its own; "marché Selembao" is in Bumbu.

Transferability: local. Buying early costs credit interest while prices are falling, which is why the date is December.

9. Croix-Rouge RDC: draft an imminent-crisis emergency fund request for Kinshasa floods now, ready to file on a Mettelsat forecast of extreme rain

CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Croix-Rouge RDC, Kinshasa provincial committee	Draft ready by 30 Nov 2026	Sized on precedent: CHF 398,745 (2022) to CHF 875,393 (2025)	Response money arriving days after the flood

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

We found no flood early action protocol for DRC, so the route is an imminent-crisis request to the IFRC Disaster Response Emergency Fund. Every Kinshasa precedent was a response request after the fact: CHF 398,745 for the December 2022 floods, which affected 16 of 24 communes, and CHF 875,393 in 2025 for floods in Kinshasa, Kongo Central, and Tanganyika. The trigger is discretionary, a Mettelsat forecast of extreme rain, with no pre-agreed threshold. DRC is not a member of the African Risk Capacity pool, and insurance covers only about 0.5% of GDP.

Transferability: the instrument is global and the Croix-Rouge has used it in Kinshasa; only the anticipatory use is new.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Bourgmestre of Selembao	Chefs de quartier and de rue	Selembao health zone	CODESA and relais	Croix-Rouge RDC	Churches	PNECHOL-MD	OVD and PRIUR	Mettelsat
1. Ravine-edge list and night refuges	**A**	**R**	**I**		**R**	**C**			**C**
2. Oral rehydration points and referral	**I**	**C**	**A/R**	**R**	**R**	**C**	**C**		
3. Household chlorine for 2,000 households	**I**	**C**	**A**	**R**	**R**				
4. Weekly cholera line list and vaccine case			**A/R**	**R**	**I**		**C**		
5. Heat checks, January to March	**C**	**R**	**A**	**R**	**C**	**R**			**I**
6. Bed nets and fever testing			**A/R**	**R**		**C**			
7. Drain map, outlets, and salongo	**A**	**R**				**C**		**R**	
8. Weekly prices and December stock	**A**	**I**							
9. Flood emergency fund request	**C**		**I**		**A/R**				**C**

What the chart shows: the Selembao health zone is accountable for four rows and the bourgmestre for three, and the chefs de quartier and de rue do the work on five. Rows 1, 4, and 7 need decisions and lists more than money.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

CDF 67.8 million (US$30,000)

TARGET

CDF 137 million (US$60,500)

CEILING

CDF 979 million (US$433,000)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Cholera in Selembao this season: no public data exist below city level

In US dollars: floor = chlorination (2,000 households × 1.50 × 5 months = 15,000) + 10 rehydration points × 1,500 = 15,000, so 30,000. Target = 30,000 + temporary rent for 50 households × 100 × 5 months = 25,000, + 10% for monitoring and the line list = 5,500, so 60,500. Ceiling = 60,500 + vaccine delivery for the health zone's 383,958 people (2015) × 0.97 a dose = 372,439, so about 433,000; the vaccine line applies only if the global stockpile committee allocates doses, which is unlikely for a zone that is not a hotspot. The target fell from the panel's 85,250 (−29%) when the chlorine was cut from 5,000 to 2,000 households.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Selembao health zone, with its CODESA committees	Action 3: household chlorine for 2,000 households for five months	CDF 33.9 million (US$15,000)	Direct grant, in tranches against stock reports	Water treatment cut under-5 deaths by about a quarter (Kremer et al. 2023, 18 trials), about CDF 90,000 (US$40) per DALY; unit cost our estimate	Partially confirmed
Selembao health zone, with Croix-Rouge volunteers	Action 2: 10 oral rehydration points, November to March	CDF 33.9 million (US$15,000)	Direct grant	Red Cross 2026 Kinshasa operation: about CDF 2.35 million (US$1,040) a point for four months, all in	Partially confirmed
Croix-Rouge RDC Kinshasa, with lists vetted by the commune	Action 1: temporary rent for 50 gully-edge households for five months	CDF 56.5 million (US$25,000)	Cash transfer	A one-bedroom house in Kinshasa rents for about CDF 452,000–678,000 (US$200–300) a month with several months in advance; no cost per death averted is published	Unverified
Selembao health zone	Action 4: monitoring and the weekly line list	CDF 12.4 million (US$5,500)	Top-up	10% of the placements; the data decide whether the next tranche is working	Partially confirmed
Provincial health division, with WHO and UNICEF (ceiling only)	Action 4: delivery of a vaccine round, only if doses are allocated	CDF 842 million (US$372,439)	Top-up	CDF 2,190 (US$0.97) a dose delivered (Malawi costing); CDF 23–43 million (US$10,165–19,212) per death averted (Ilboudo et al. 2021, Malawi)	Partially confirmed

The funder's one thing: make the weekly cholera line list for each Selembao health area a condition of every tranche. It costs almost nothing, it is what decides whether the pre-arranged CERF money can fire here, and without it no one can tell whether the chlorine is averting deaths. We found no household-level duplication with CERF's 2025 allocation, UNICEF's 2026 appeal, or the Red Cross's 2026 operation, which ended in July. The 2026 humanitarian response plan for DRC sought CDF 4.82 trillion (US$2.13 billion) and was 50.5% funded on 28 September, mostly for the east.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here, each checked against a documented case.

Do not fill a gully head with sandbags or rubbish

CONTRAINDICATED

Water undermines the joints between sandbags, so any stability is "temporary and therefore apparent"; studies at Kisenso and Mbanza Lemba describe sandbag works giving way, and communes still use them. A World Bank-financed repair at the Drève de Selembao gully began in 2004 with 80,000 sandbags planted with vetiver. Refuse plugs are common and unevaluated.

Instead: cut the water upstream, by diverting roof and road runoff and extending drains to a protected outlet (action 7).

Do not build a drain or channel that ends on a slope

CONTRAINDICATED

Concentrated water is what cuts gullies in Kinshasa's sand: 43.8% of the city's mega-gullies sit on roads, gutters, and paths, and the Ngafani collector gully took 27 plots in two rains. A drain that stops on a slope is "un danger énorme" (Makanzu Imwangana).

Instead: fund no drain without a designed, armoured outfall at the bottom.

Do not run a drain-cleaning day that tips the waste and sand into the ravine

CONTRAINDICATED UNVERIFIED

Waste dumped into drains blocks them and starts new erosion; a press report from Kinshasa in August 2026 described this at Kenge Yaba. This card rests on that one report and on the general gully evidence.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: arrange collection and haulage before the cleaning starts; Kin La Belle, the World Bank waste programme, is the place to ask.

Do not clear ravine edges or demolish houses without a relocation site and money in hand

CONTRAINDICATED

More than 100 families from the Funa site in the commune of Kinshasa had been sleeping outdoors for more than two months as of January 2026, after demolitions. Studies of the N'djili basin found that people who were compensated often sold their new plot and came back. A household that expects eviction will not tell the chef de rue it is at risk.

Instead: voluntary, compensated moves, and temporary refuge on heavy-rain nights (action 1).

Do not give heat advice that depends on SNEL power

CONTRAINDICATED

Power supply in Kinshasa degraded for several weeks in October 2026, and residents of Kintambo petitioned over outages in January. A fan or a cooling centre that needs the grid fails when the heat is worst.

Instead: shade, night ventilation, water, and daily checks on the people most at risk (action 5).*

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1990	The Drève de Selembao gully opens: 1,300 m long, 60 m wide, 12 m deep (ENSO neutral)	6 dead and 71 homes destroyed by 2006 (Stevens; another study gives 5 and 80)	A World Bank-financed repair with 80,000 sandbags and vetiver began in 2004
2002–03	Survey of Kinshasa's gullies	212 gullies; 2,400 houses destroyed citywide	Nothing systematic

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YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2017–18	Cholera in Kinshasa, worsened by the January 2018 floods (La Niña)	1,065 cases, 43 deaths	—
Nov 2019	Floods, worst in Lemba and Mont-Ngafula (weak El Niño)	39–41 dead	—
13 Dec 2022	Overnight rain floods Kinshasa; Selembao among the worst-hit communes (La Niña)	169 dead (OCHA); 12 in Selembao in a partial count	Red Cross response request, CHF 398,745
4–5 Apr 2025	Floods, mainly the N'djili river in the east (ENSO neutral)	At least 72 dead by 13 April, drowned or under collapsing walls	Governor warns against permits in no-build zones; demolitions announced after a six-month grace period
Jun 2025	One night of rain brings walls down in Ngaliema and Lemba	22 dead	—
Apr–Jul 2025	Cholera in 27 of Kinshasa's 35 health zones	More than 1,500 suspected cases and 120 deaths	CERF trigger fired on 24 July; vaccination in seven zones on 19–23 August, not Selembao
20 Feb 2026	The Makelele overflows into Mwanantukulu, Selembao	No deaths in Selembao (2 in Mont-Ngafula); families left their plots	Damage assessed; no relief operation reported

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Kinshasa's deadliest storms have come in La Niña, neutral, and weak El Niño years alike, and El Niño does not reliably change the city's rain. Prepare for the rainy-season calendar, not the forecast. And every gully repair here since 2004 that was not maintained failed within a few rainy seasons: maintenance is the intervention.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **"El Niño brings heavy rain to Kinshasa"** (Food supply, citing the November–December 2015 floods) versus **"El Niño does not reliably change Kinshasa's rain"** (Historian, Emergency manager, and verification). Studies find no reliable ENSO link for the western Congo basin,

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the 2015 link rests on one press "probably", and this season's regional forecast says nothing specific for Kinshasa. We side with no reliable link; a station-level study for Kinshasa would settle it.

- **Clear the ravine edges by order** (the April 2025 provincial announcement) versus **voluntary, compensated moves** (Frontline, Skeptic). The Funa case shows what eviction without a site does; the open question is who pays for the sites.
- **Stock food early** (Food supply) versus **wait while prices fall** (verification). Sack prices are down about a quarter since June, so we moved the date to December.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens covered sanitation: in a flood, pit latrines on the slopes overflow into the same water people drink, which is how floods turn into cholera. Nor did any lens cover acute malnutrition in children, measles, or mpox. And Cité Verte's population is not published; Selembao's figures range from 335,581 (2004) to an implausible 1,038,819 (2015), so every per-person number here is soft. The ravine-edge list (action 1) would give the first real count of the people most at risk.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

The Climate Impact Lab figure here is published for Kinshasa as a whole, at province level; it is not a neighbourhood figure. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; floods, gullies, cholera, and malaria are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: Cité Verte, a quartier and health area of Selembao commune, Kinshasa, at its southwest tip beside Mont-Ngafula. It is the commune's one planned estate, built by LOGEC in the early 1980s (375 villas in one thesis, 442 dwellings in another); no population is published. Because the risk sits on its edges, the actions cover the estate's fringe and the nearby quartiers of Kingu-

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Camping, Herady, and Ngafani. Climate Impact Lab figures are available only for Kinshasa (province level); no impact region was resolved. Sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): Kinshasa, 330 additional heat deaths June–September 2026, 1,600 forecast October 2026 – March 2027 (October 100, November 170, December 240, January 300, February 340, March 480), 1,900 in total; DR Congo, 24,700; the world, 857,400. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a 1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only; we inferred this from the data, because cold countries show exactly zero in every winter month. They are never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources in French and English, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in DRC, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. Food actions were checked for whether each price series is actually published, and how often. A separate check tested whether El Niño changes Kinshasa's rainfall.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted. Its "Download Inventory" link leads to a registration form, and the browse page loads its data in the browser. No action here should be read as having no precedent; none was checked.

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- **Money.** Costs are shown in Congolese francs with US dollars in parentheses, at CDF 2,261.56 = US$1 (Banque Centrale du Congo indicative rate, 30 October 2026). The parallel rate was CDF 2,327.89 on 9 October, about 2.7% weaker. Daily life in Kinshasa is heavily dollarised, and most source costs are in dollars.
- **Reader.** This briefing was built at El Niño Ready's initiative, not from a request. No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. The "For you" steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about residents here; any step not drawn from a ranked action was verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the commune, the health zone, and their partners.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (floods and gullies, oral rehydration salts and zinc, water treatment, malaria and fever, and heat) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Several ACP, allAfrica, and ReliefWeb pages returned errors, so some figures rest on search excerpts. No source mentions Cité Verte by name together with erosion, flooding, or cholera; most figures are for Selembao or Kinshasa. The 2014 Katalayi thesis on Kinshasa's urbanisation is cited by name only, because its hosting link now redirects to an unrelated site. Unit costs for chlorine, rent, and household items are estimates. The locator map shows Kinshasa at country scale; the quartier itself is not drawn.

References · status after verification

Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026); tracker · confirmed

Floods: Al Jazeera, Dec 2022; OCHA flash update, Dec 2022; April 2025 floods; April 2025 toll; ACP, wall collapses, June 2025; Makelele, Feb 2026; Al Jazeera, Dec 2015 · corrected

Gullies: Makanzu Imwangana et al. 2014; Lutete Landu et al., retention pits; sandbag failures, Kisenso; Noffke, Selembao 2004 repair; Kenge Yaba, Aug 2026 · corrected

Demolition and relocation: Funa families, Jan 2026; ACP, no-build zones, April 2025; Vatican News, April 2025 · corrected

Cholera: deaths at home, July 2025; Kinshasa 2025 counts; WHO AFRO, Q1 2026; Pakadjuma and MSF exit; IFRC MDRCD049, hotspots and costs; ACP, Aug 2025 vaccination; Malembaka et al. 2024 · corrected

Water: Selembao water shortage, Jan 2026; REGIDESO outages, April 2025; Kremer et al., NBER w30835; Munos et al. 2010 · corrected

Malaria: Ferrari et al. 2016; Pryce et al., Cochrane 2018; Kinshasa net campaign, Jan 2024; net survival: DRC study, DuraNet; routine channels:

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PMC9719175 · corrected

Heat and power: Kinshasa climatology; Hess et al. 2018; SNEL supply, Oct 2026; Kintambo petition, Jan 2026 · corrected

Finance: CERF cholera anticipatory action, Kinshasa; IFRC MDRCD039; IFRC MDRCD046; PRIUR terms of reference; Kin La Belle; HRP funding, Sep 2026; ARC treaty status; insurance market; SIM re-registration · corrected

Food: CAID basket, April 2026; ACP cassava prices, 13 Oct 2026; Selembao market in Bumbu: ACP, Jan 2025 · corrected

Money: Banque Centrale du Congo, 30 Oct 2026; ACP, 9 Oct 2026 · confirmed

Rainfall and ENSO: Congo basin rainfall and ENSO; NOAA ONI · confirmed

Place: Katalayi Mutombo, *Urbanisation et fabrique urbaine à Kinshasa* (thesis, 2014), cited by name; Selembao; health zone population: 2015 study · corrected

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 30 October 2026 for Cité Verte, Kinshasa. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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